

Name _____

Word Count: 160

The Ranch Helpers

Grace stopped talking in the middle of a sentence. She squinted nervously down at the grass. "Oh, okay," she said. "It's only a fly. I was afraid it was a bee."

"You hate bees, don't you?" Bill asked.

"I was stung once," said Grace. "They're the scariest insects ever."

Bill laughed. "Well, on our ranch, we rent bees to pollinate our trees."

"You pay to borrow bees?" Grace asked with surprise.

"Yes," said Bill. "We need them so we can grow almonds. Come by some time. You can see them working."

That weekend, Grace visited the ranch. She admired the machines Bill's family used to grow and gather almonds.

"People have invented amazing machines," Bill agreed. "But without the bees, we'd still have no almonds. You'll have to come again next summer to see our abundant harvest!"

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Just then, a bee landed on a flower near Grace. “I guess I shouldn’t hate bees,” she said. “They’re useful for some things!”